



TRIOS CYBER

LABORATORY PRACTICE 29

SOC Incident Report

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1. Incident Summary

A cluster of five failed authentication events was detected on a monitored Windows endpoint within approximately 38 seconds. The events targeted the same local user account and were classified by Wazuh as "Logon Failure - Unknown user or bad password" under rule 60122 at level 5. The activity was investigated as a brute-force-style authentication pattern and correlated with Windows Security Event ID 4625.

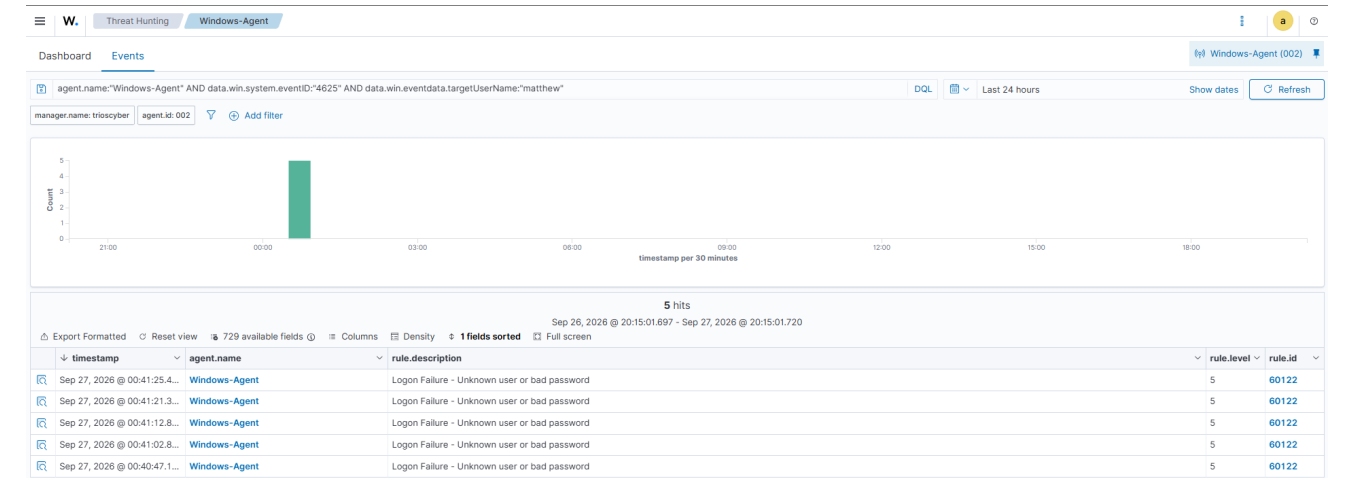
Incident element	Observed value	SOC interpretation
Alert pattern	5 repeated failed logons	Short burst of repeated authentication failures
Wazuh alert	Rule 60122 / Level 5	Authentication failure detection
Windows event	Security Event ID 4625	Failed account logon telemetry
Target account	matthew	Same account targeted repeatedly
Final disposition	Authorized controlled activity	No confirmed malicious compromise

2. Affected Asset

Field	Observed value	Meaning
Endpoint	Windows-Agent	Monitored Windows endpoint
Agent ID	002	Wazuh agent identifier
IP address	10.10.20.30	Endpoint address recorded by Wazuh
Computer	DESKTOP-VOJCDSO	Windows host recorded in the event
Target user	matthew	Account associated with the failed logons
Source address	127.0.0.1	Local source for the selected event

3. Incident Timeline

Time (Sep 27, 2026)	Event	Assessment
~00:40:47	First matching Event ID 4625 recorded	Start of the repeated-failure sequence
00:41:12.848	Selected failed-logon alert reviewed in Wazuh	Detailed event used for evidence analysis
~00:41:25	Fifth matching failed-logon event recorded	End of the observed burst



Wazuh Threat Hunting view showing five matching failed-logon alerts.

4. Evidence

The investigation used endpoint and centralized telemetry to establish the event context. Windows Security records identify Event ID 4625, target user matthew, local source address 127.0.0.1, network logon type 3, and NTLM authentication. Wazuh correlates the same activity under rule 60122 at level 5.

Evidence source	Key observation	Relevance
Windows Security	Event ID 4625 / AUDIT_FAILURE	Confirms failed account logon
Wazuh Threat Hunting	5 matching alerts	Confirms repetition and central visibility
Selected event detail	127.0.0.1 / source port 49833	Identifies source context
Authentication context	Logon type 3 / NtLmSsp / NTLM	Identifies network authentication method
Wazuh rule	60122 / Level 5	Central alert classification

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matthew@DESKTOP-V0JCDSO C:\Users\matthew>type C:\Users\matthew\Documents\Incident_DAY26\02_Logs\Failed_Logons_4625.txt
Event[0]:
  Log Name: Security
  Source: Microsoft-Windows-Security-Auditing
  Date: 2026-09-27T00:41:22.7010000Z
  Event ID: 4625
  Task: Logon
  Level: Information
  Opcode: Information
  Keyword: Error de auditoría
  User: N/A
  User Name: N/A
  Computer: DESKTOP-V0JCDSO
  Description:
    Error de una cuenta al iniciar sesión.

  Sujeto:
    Id. de seguridad: S-1-0-0
    Nombre de cuenta: -
    Dominio de cuenta: -
    Id. de inicio de sesión: 0x0

  Tipo de inicio de sesión: 3

  Cuenta con error de inicio de sesión:
    Id. de seguridad: S-1-0-0
    Nombre de cuenta: matthew
    Dominio de cuenta: DESKTOP-V0JCDSO

  Información de error:
    Motivo del error: Nombre de usuario desconocido o contraseña incorrecta
    Estado: 0xc000006d
    Subestado: 0xc000006a

  Información de proceso:
    Id. de proceso del autor de la llamada: 0x0
    Nombre de proceso del autor de la llamada: -

  Información de red:
    Nombre de estación de trabajo: DESKTOP-V0JCDSO
    Dirección de red de origen: 127.0.0.1
    Puerto de origen: 49837

  Información de autenticación detallada:
    Proceso de inicio de sesión: NtLmSsp
    Paquete de autenticación: -
    Servicios transitados: -
    Nombre de paquete (solo NTLM): -
    Longitud de clave: 0
```

Windows Security evidence for the selected Event ID 4625 failed logon.

5. Severity and Analysis

Assessment	Value	Reasoning
Detection severity	Wazuh Level 5	Repeated invalid-credential activity required investigation
Final SOC severity	Low	Activity was confirmed as authorized and controlled
Incident status	Closed - benign / authorized test	No evidence in the reviewed record required containment

The five events occurred against the same account in a short time window, which is consistent with a brute-force-style pattern and would normally justify further triage. The selected event shows incorrect-credential status/substatus values, a local source address, and network logon type 3 using NTLM. Because the activity was intentionally generated as an authorized test, the observed pattern does not represent a confirmed compromise.

Analyst assessment: The alert was valid and the telemetry was correctly correlated. The security significance changed after contextual review: the repeated failures were expected test activity rather than unexplained hostile authentication attempts.

6. Actions Taken

Action	Result	Status
Filtered Wazuh events by endpoint, Event ID 4625, and target user	Isolated five matching failed-logon records	Completed
Reviewed Windows Security event data	Confirmed target account and incorrect-credential condition	Completed
Reviewed Wazuh Document Details	Validated rule, severity, source, authentication fields, and timestamp	Completed
Correlated the five records into one short incident timeline	Established the repeated-failure pattern	Completed
Preserved supporting event evidence for reporting	Maintained endpoint and Wazuh context	Completed
Applied contextual disposition	Authorized controlled activity; no containment action required	Completed

7. Escalation and Recommendation

Escalation decision: No escalation was required because the activity was authorized and locally generated. The alert was investigated, validated, and documented before closure.

For an equivalent unexplained pattern in a production environment, escalate for deeper investigation. Recommended triage should verify the target account, source IP, logon type, number and timing of failures, and whether any successful authentication followed the failed attempts. If the source is untrusted or the activity persists, consider account protection, source blocking, credential reset, and broader endpoint review according to organizational procedures.

8. Validation Summary

Requirement	Observed result	Status
Summary	Five repeated failed-authentication events documented	Completed
Affected asset	Windows-Agent / ID 002 / 10.10.20.30	Verified
Timeline	~00:40:47 to ~00:41:25 on Sep 27, 2026	Verified
Evidence	Windows Event ID 4625 + Wazuh rule 60122	Verified
Severity	Level 5 detection; Low final SOC severity	Assessed
Analysis	Brute-force-style pattern with authorized context	Completed
Actions / recommendation	Investigation completed; no escalation; production guidance recorded	Completed

9. Conclusions

The SOC incident investigation documented five failed authentication events affecting Windows-Agent and target account matthew. Windows Security Event ID 4625 and Wazuh rule 60122 at level 5 provided consistent evidence of repeated invalid-credential activity within a short time window. Detailed event analysis identified the local source, network logon type, NTLM authentication context, and the affected endpoint. The activity was ultimately classified as authorized controlled testing, so no real incident escalation or containment was required. An equivalent unexplained pattern in production should be escalated and investigated for possible credential abuse or brute-force activity.